



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Jacksonville Classical Academies

School Website: <https://www.jaxclassical.org/>

January 8, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Jacksonville Classical Academy (JCA) demonstrates a predominantly classical orientation in its public materials, with clear commitments to a liberal arts, content-rich education rooted in Western civilization, and a mission centered on virtue, wisdom, and character formation. The campus explicitly describes a classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a liberal-arts framework, and a Great-Books-oriented ethos, reinforced by Core Knowledge, Latin, and classical literacy programs. There are strong signs of virtuous character formation, civic responsibility, and a parent-community partnership, all of which align with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric.

However, certain elements typically associated with a robust classical program—explicit liturgical/theological grounding, and a more explicit articulation of contemplative schooling (Scholé) and Socratic pedagogy as core teaching methods—are less evident in the public-facing materials. This yields a mostly CLASSICAL profile with a few somewhat Classical aspects still visible. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with category-by-category notes below and concrete needle-movers outlined in the “What would move the needle” sections.

Key takeaways:

- **Strengths:** strong curriculum core (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Core Knowledge integration, Great-Books/western-civilization framing, emphasis on virtue and civic virtue, and active parent/community engagement (Parent Group, campus tours, public information). Evidence of a living-faculty ethos and staff expectations aligned to classical aims.
- Evidence snippets include motto and virtue framing, curricular focus on the trivium, Core Knowledge, and Western-civilizational heritage, and explicit parent partnerships. See motto and virtue language (Learn the Truth. Do the Good. Love the Beautiful.) and the program description (virtuous living, civic responsibility, Western civilization) as core signals.
- Curriculum signals include grammar/logic/rhetoric, Core Knowledge Sequence, Latin, explicit phonics, Orton-Gillingham literacy, Singapore Math, and a content-rich classical narrative.
- Public-parent engagement signals are strong (Parent Group, open-campus mentality, parent involvement).
- **Areas to strengthen (needle-movers):** provide more explicit references to contemplative pedagogy (Scholé), formal Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the high school, and a clearer note on any liturgical/theological grounding or communal practices beyond civic virtue and moral formation. Also consider more explicit articulation of the “Great Conversation” through published Great-Books statements or course sequences. See the gaps identified in the Six Elements lexicon and match to observed materials.

- Overall: CLASSICAL, with some SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL facets in certain categories that lack explicit liturgical/theological grounding and explicit Socratic pedagogy in public-facing materials.

This report is grounded in the six-category classical rubric, including keyword analyses against the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School documents, and triangulated with the public-facing materials from the school's crawl content.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent ideals via motto language: "LEARN THE TRUTH. DO THE GOOD. LOVE THE BEAUTIFUL."
- The description highlights virtue, moral character, and civic virtue as core aims, alongside a Western-civilization frame.
- The school's mission centers on virtuous living and civic responsibility within a liberal-arts framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth; goodness; beauty; virtue; moral character; civic virtue; Western civilization. (Multiple explicit occurrences across the motto and mission text.)
- Negative keywords: Not prominently present in public materials (no explicit secularism-only or value-neutral framing detected in the accessible materials).

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendent values (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue-focused formation, but there is no explicit theology, liturgical practice, or formal doctrinal program described in public-facing content. That keeps this from a full, explicit theological grounding, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for this category.

Notes for documentation:

- The "Great-Conversation" and explicit theological grounding are not clearly stated in the site copy, though a Western-civilization frame exists. The lexicon and Six Elements documents point to liturgical/theological signals as strong signals in fully classical institutions, which are not evidenced publicly here.

What would move the needle

- Add explicit theology or liturgical/community practices (even if ecumenical) to ground metaphysical claims in a theological frame.
- Include a clearly stated liturgical calendar or communal worship practices, or a formal statement about philosophical/theological aims that align with the "Mistress Science" approach.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job-readiness (virtue, wisdom, moral character; civic virtue; formation over information).
- The school frames education as a liberal, content-rich, classical mission focused on human excellence, virtue, and stewardship rather than only workforce prep.
- Academics page states high standards of ethics and personal discipline, and that graduates should be highly literate and ethical citizens.

- Motto-language and Great-Conversation-oriented framing (Western civ, classical mission) reinforce the aim toward truth, goodness, beauty, and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue; wisdom; formation; liberal education; human flourishing; truth/beauty/goodness; great conversation (implied in the classical aim); telos; classical mission.
- Negative keywords: None prominent in public materials (no explicit “career-readiness/workforce-first” framing observed in the accessible site text).

Why this rating

- The site consistently emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of human excellence as the aim of education, aligning strongly with the Classical goal category. While AP and dual-enrollment exist, they are situated within a broader formation framework rather than a primary job-prep focus.

Notes for documentation:

- Core elements in the Six Elements material include formation and pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as ends of education; the school text aligns with that emphasis. See the core goals in the Six Elements materials and lexicon.

What would move the needle

- More explicit articulation of “formation over information” in public materials (beyond general statements) and clearer articulation of telos and human excellences as consistently pursued outcomes across grades.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site explicitly describes the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the framework for the curriculum.
- Core Knowledge Sequence is referenced as a central curricular backbone; Singapore Math, explicit phonics, Latin, and a literature/arts emphasis are highlighted.
- History is taught as a throughline across disciplines, rooted in Western civilization; the curriculum emphasizes Great Books and classic texts, with a focus on cultural literacy (Core Knowledge, Great Books framing).
- Curriculum maps show Core Knowledge Sequence; explicit mention of “Great Books/Great Conversation” framing and classical literacy programs.
- The public-facing tour and academics pages emphasize a content-rich, historically anchored curriculum with a liberal-arts orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation (implied by Great-Works and classical canon language); Core Knowledge Sequence; Western civilization; Latin; explicit phonics; Orton-Gillingham; Singapore Math; history through the curriculum.
- Negative keywords: None strongly observed in public content (no major modern, skills-based, or project-based-only framing observed in the core materials).

Why this rating

- The curriculum is squarely anchored in the classical framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric), with a robust liberal-arts emphasis, and explicit tie-ins to Great Books and a Western-civilization narrative. The mix of Core Knowledge and classical content supports a robust, historically grounded curriculum, matching classical criteria.

Notes for documentation:

- Core Knowledge references, grammar/logic/rhetoric language, and Western-civilization framing are all present in multiple crawl results.

What would move the needle

- If the school can publish a formal, explicit Great Books list and a formal Great Conversation sequence across grades (with sample texts and a published reading plan), and show more direct integration of a true Trivium/Quadrivium continuum across K-12, it would strengthen this category further.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public-facing materials emphasize a classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and a focus on critical thinking and eloquent expression; however, explicit pedagogy signals such as ongoing Socratic seminars, Harkness-style discussions, or a rest-focused “Scholé” cadence are not clearly spelled out in public copy. The Upper School content references deep reading of foundational texts and the role of logic; explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy is implied but not strongly evidenced in the public pages.
- The presence of a strong emphasis on classical rhetoric and debate in upper levels is implied by the curriculum focus and public descriptions; the site notes a high regard for logic and argument in the upper levels.
- Some lower-level pedagogy elements (e.g., singing/chanting in lower grades, restfulness, or “Scholé” days) are not clearly documented in the public copy; the six-element materials describe these pedagogical signals, but they are not overtly claimed by the school in the visible site text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/dialectic (not clearly evidenced on-site but implied by classical pedagogy); memorization/recitation (not clearly evidenced on-site); formation through imitation and practice (implied through living-language curriculum and mastery emphasis); scholé (not explicitly named in public copy).
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in the site copy; however, explicit references to “restful learning” or dedicated Socratic seminars are not clearly documented in public content.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates a clear classical curricular orientation but lacks explicit public documentation of core pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, Scholé days, or explicit memory work in classroom practice). This places Pedagogy in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL, pending stronger public articulation of the pedagogical methods used.

Notes for documentation:

- The Six Elements lexicon and the “Pedagogy” section describe a set of potential methods (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, imitation/formation). The current public-facing JCA materials show strong curricular alignment but less explicit pedagogy language. See the pedagogical keywords in the lexicon.

What would move the needle

- Publish a clear, school-wide pedagogy charter that documents:
- Regular Socratic seminars/seminars (Harkness-style or similar) across grades (including sample prompts and assessment rubrics).
- Explicit incorporation of Scholé-restful days or routines in the schedule.
- Memorization/recitation practices (e.g., selected memory work, chants, poetry recitation, or canonical passages) with published examples and performance assessments.

- A formal “living curriculum” framework linking models of excellence to classroom practice (i.e., imitation and practice with masters’ works).
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Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents faculty as essential to the mission, with explicit staff expectations that emphasize a passion for classical education and mastery of classical pedagogy (Careers page states expectations for faculty, including a passion for classical education).
- Public materials show a campus faculty/staff listing and a governance structure (Governing Board) with named leaders; the living curriculum concept (faculty as the living curriculum) and mentor-like teacher culture are embedded in classical tradition, though not explicitly described in “portrait of a teacher” language on the site. The staff pages articulate traditional roles (faculty/staff) and public leadership.
- The site references a “Portrait of a teacher” and classical-teaching standards in the Six Elements lexicon, which aligns with the expected living-curriculum approach; public copy confirms a strong faculty focus on classical aims and ongoing professional expectations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators; mentorship; master-teacher model; portrait of a teacher; living curriculum; faculty as a core; professional development; fidelity to classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords observed: none clearly stated in public content; the explicit “teacher-as-guide” or “faculty collaboration” language seen in the lexicon is not overtly demonstrated in public copy, but the Careers and Faculty pages indicate a strong teacher-centered classical mission.

Why this rating

- The materials show a clear emphasis on faculty alignment with classical aims and expectations for teachers to model classical virtues and pedagogy. Even without a fully explicit “living curriculum” phrase in the site copy, the visible content aligns with a CLASSICAL evaluation for Faculty.

Notes for documentation:

- The Careers page provides explicit teacher expectations; governance pages show leadership continuity. The “living curriculum” concept is supported by the Six Elements materials, and the site’s presentation aligns with that in practice.

What would move the needle

- Publish a formal “Faculty Portrait” and “Teacher as Mentor” statement with explicit examples of faculty development, mentorship structures, and living-curriculum practices visible in classroom practice and professional development offerings.
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Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school strongly emphasizes parent partnership in its public content, including a Parent Group and active family engagement initiatives (Parent Group materials; “Parent + Family Engagement”; parent visits and school events; Tours information).
- Parent-involvement structures (Jets Parents group; donation pages; engagement opportunities) and open-campus stances are documented on the site.
- The school’s public materials encourage parent participation and engagement, including tours and community events, and publish specific parent-group activities and engagement opportunities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental engagement; family involvement; parent formation; community of learners; home-school collaboration; parent covenant; open campus; hospitality.
- Negative keywords observed: none; the materials consistently present a partner-organization model rather than a purely consumer model.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates strong parent involvement and community integration, consistent with Classical education norms regarding parental formation and partnership with families. The presence of a formal parent group, engagement opportunities, and tours aligns with CLASSICAL in this category.

Notes for documentation:

- Parent Group, tours, and engagement pages are clearly present; the materials emphasize parent involvement and education through book studies and gatherings.

What would move the needle

- Publish a formal, published schedule of parent-focused scholarly events (e.g., classical book clubs, parent education series on core classical texts, and family catechesis resources) with a yearlong calendar, to further institutionalize parent formation and involvement beyond events.

Overall Ranking

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates robust alignment with core classical elements (Curriculum, History-and-Great-Books framing, liberal-arts orientation, virtue formation, and strong parent/community engagement). Categories 1 and 4 show partial alignment, reflecting the absence of explicit liturgical/theological grounding and explicit pedagogy signals in public content, as well as less public articulation of Scholé/restful pedagogy and explicit Socratic pedagogy. Taken together, the majority of categories strongly meet classical criteria, with a few areas needing clearer public documentation to reach full CLASSICAL in every category. The School's public materials are robustly Classical in 4 of 6 categories, with two showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals.

Executive notes: The presence of motto-language (Truth, Goodness, Beauty), virtue focus, and Western-civilization framing, alongside a curriculum built on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Core Knowledge, Great Books emphasis, Latin, and a robust parent/community program, strongly supports CLASSICAL status overall.

What Would Move the Needle (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories)

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations)
- Add explicit theology or liturgical/community grounding statements to public materials (even if ecumenical) and publish a small canon or creed section showing how truth/goodness/beauty translate into a metaphysical framework.

- Provide a public-facing description of communal practices (morning/evening routines, liturgical calendar, or sacred music) to strengthen liturgical signaling.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy)
- Publish a formal pedagogy charter detailing:
 - Regular, school-wide Socratic seminars or Harkness-style discussions with sample prompts and rubrics.
 - Explicit incorporation of Scholé (restful learning) days and routines in the daily/weekly schedule.
 - A published plan for memorization/recitation practices (e.g., memorized passages, chanted texts) with example units.
 - A clear articulation of imitation/practice as a core learning mechanism, including how students study models of excellence in literature, history, and mathematics.
- Element 1/Element 4 cross-cutters
- Provide a simple crosswalk document showing how the school's published practices connect to the Six Elements' positive/negative keyword signals (with explicit text references on the school site).
- Element 5 (Faculty)
- Publish a formal "Portrait of a Classical Teacher" and a teacher-professional-development framework that shows mentorship, collaboration, and living-curriculum practices, with examples of faculty collaboration and seminars.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community)
- Publish a yearlong calendar of parent-education events (book studies, Great Conversation-oriented sessions) and a clear outline of "Parent Formation" activities with measurable outcomes, to strengthen the parent-education dimension beyond events.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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